

Yisong Zhao

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Human-AI Interaction & Co-Creative Systems
- Embodied VR & Multisensory Interaction
- Digital Mental Wellbeing

EDUCATION BACKGROUND

University of the Arts London (UAL), Creative Computing Institute

06/2025-11/2026 (Expected)

Master of Science (M.Sc.) in Creative Computing (Expected)

- **Degree Classification:** Merit (Expected)
- **Relevant Modules:** Creative Making: Advanced Computational Creativity and Responsive Environments, Creative Making: Advanced Physical Computing and Tangible Media, Critical Coding: Advanced Creative Practice, Engaging Machine Intelligence
- **Honours & Awards:**
 - Silver Award, Muse Design Award 2025 (for product design)

LuXun Academy of Fine Arts (LAFA), School of Sino-British Digital Media Art (in partnership with the University of Salford, UK)

09/2021-06/2025

Bachelor of Fine Arts (B.F.A.) in Digital Media Art

- **GPA:** 80.9
- **Relevant Modules:** Human-centred & VR, Human - Computer Interaction, Interactive & Game Design, Spatial Interaction & Creative Coding, Visual Communication & Narrative Design
- **Academic Scholarships:**
 - University-Level Individual Scholarship, 2023
 - University-Level Third-Class Academic Scholarship, 2023
- **Design & Competition Awards:**
 - Silver Award, 3rd FA International Frontier Innovation Art & Design Competition (*BMW Sensory Fusion: Multisensory Interactive Space*), organised by French Federation of Design Industries, 2024
 - Bronze Award, CADA - 5th Japan Concept Art Design Award (for *Business Logo Design*), organised by Japan Osaka Visual Art Association & Korea Commercial Design Association, 2023
 - First Prize (for *HBN Radiance Moment*) & Third Prize (for *Moments in time, memories for life*), The 15th National Advertising Art Design Competition for College Students (Graphic Design Category), 08/2023
 - Bronze Award, HKAD - 4th Hong Kong Contemporary Design Award (for *Brand Logo & Web Design*), organised by Hong Kong Art and Design Association & Hong Kong Art and Design Research Institute, 2022
 - Bronze Award, ITCD - International Trend Design Award (for *College Student Psychological Counseling APP*), organised by American Art Exchange Association & North American University Design Union (NAUD), 2022

PUBLICATIONS

Zhao, Y. Reinforcement Learning-Based Adaptive Human-Computer Interaction for V2X-Assisted Autonomous Vehicle Obstacle Avoidance. Revised after peer review; currently in post-review processing at *Tehnički vjesnik – Technical Gazette* (SCI-indexed).

Zhao, Y. (2025). Exploring the Application of Touch Interaction in the Digitalization of Cultural Heritage. *Proceedings of the 2025 2nd International Conference on Modern Education, Humanities and Art (MEHA 2025)*. Zhengzhou, China, September 27–28, 2025 (Paper ID: A20250827151800). DOI: 10.62381/acs.meha2025.03. (CPCI indexing pending).

Pang, Z., & **Zhao, Y.** (2024). Microcontroller Elevator Scheduling System Based on Intelligent Optimization Algorithms. *Proceedings of the 2024 4th International Conference on Internet of Things and Smart City (IoTSC 2024)*. Hangzhou, China, March 22 – 24, 2024. SPIE, Vol. 13224, Article No. 132241]. DOI: 10.1117/12.3034975. (ISSN: 0277-786X; E-ISSN: 1996-756X; indexed in EI Compendex).

SELECTED DESIGN PROJECTS

InterPlay | Digital Interaction Exhibition

05/2026

Organised by UAL | Copeland Gallery, London

- **Symmetry Kingdom | Embodied & Gamified Interaction:** Co-developed a wearable gamified interaction system that transmitted wrist-motion data captured by an Arduino-based 3D-printed controller to the Unity, enabling control and LED feedback during gameplay.
- **Filter Bubble | Spatial & Gesture-Based Interaction:** Co-designed a TouchDesigner system using MediaPipe hand tracking and pinch gestures, enabling users to select visual information and observe how repeated selections reduce information diversity.

Emblem and Mascot Design for the 15th National Winter Games 2028

11/2024-02/2025

Supervisor: Prof. Dexu Xiu

- **Visual Design Leadership:** Took primary responsibility for the core visual identity, designing the official emblem and mascot concepts for a major national sporting event using Adobe Illustrator.
- **3D Visualisation & Presentation:** Translated 2D design sketches into detailed 3D models using Maya, Cinema 4D and Octane Render, creating dynamic visualisations for stakeholder presentation and approval.

- **Collaborative Development:** Worked under professorial supervision to iteratively refine designs based on feedback, ensuring alignment with the Games' thematic requirements and cultural significance.

Visual Identity for Northeast China Fine Arts & Design Job Fair

04/2023

Supervisor: Prof. Ruhe Zhang

- **AI-Driven Concept Development:** Conducted visual research and Midjourney prompt engineering, generating iterative AI imagery aligned with Procreate sketches to refine composition, material cues and atmosphere.
- **Integrated Digital Design Execution:** Collaborated with the instructor, employed Figma for professional layout and typography to produce the final visual poster and surrounding promotional materials.

UI Design for Dadong District Government Emergency Mobile App

09/2022-10/2022

- **End-to-End UI/UX Design:** Served as the UI Designer for a pandemic-response application, responsible for the entire visual design process from initial wireframing in Figma to high-fidelity interface mockups in Adobe Illustrator.
- **User-Centred Information Architecture:** Designed the application's Information Architecture (IA) and user flows, focusing on clarity and efficiency to aid public communication during emergencies.
- **Collaborative Implementation Support:** Worked alongside the development team to ensure design feasibility and optimal user experience across different mobile device platforms.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Poktaitech (Shenyang) Co., Ltd.

03/2026-04/2026

VR/AR Interactive Game Design Intern

- **Wearable Interaction Development:** Developed functionalities for wearable interactive devices using Arduino and Unity as part of a commissioned VR/AR game development project.
- **User Research & Optimisation:** Conducted user interviews and deployed questionnaires to analyse interaction pathways, supporting prototype testing and iterative improvements to the user operation flow.

China Southern Airlines Group Import & Export Trading Corp., Ltd.

01/2024-03/2024

Modelling, Rendering & Editing Intern

- **3D Asset Creation:** Modelled and rendered 3D assets for company peripherals (e.g., airline doll) using Cinema 4D and Octane Render, meeting brand visual standards.
- **Promotional Video Production:** Assisted in editing promotional video content using Adobe Premiere Pro, contributing to the final marketing deliverables.

Daxiang Technology Co., Ltd., Shenyang

01/2023-02/2023

Teaching Assistant

- **Software & Skill Instruction:** Supported lead faculty by guiding colleagues from non-design departments in learning foundational design software (Adobe Illustrator, Unity, Maya, Cinema 4D) and core concepts (Design Thinking, Typesetting).
- **Cross-Departmental Support:** Facilitated practical workshops and provided one-on-one assistance, ensuring trainees could effectively apply new skills to their respective projects.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Noitom Digital Capability Enhancement Training

06/2022

- Completed professional training in VR/XR, wearable technologies, spatial tracking .
- Explored how wearable devices and motion/spatial tracking can be applied to embodied interaction and immersive experience.

SKILLS & INTERESTS

- **Languages:** Mandarin (Native), English (Fluent).
- **IT & Design Software:**
 - *Design & Prototyping:* Adobe Illustrator, Photoshop, Figma, Midjourney
 - *3D & Motion Graphics:* Unity, Maya, Cinema 4D, Octane Render, Unreal Engine 5, Adobe After Effects, Blender
 - *Video & Post-Production:* Adobe Premiere Pro, CapCut
 - *Development & Creative Coding:* GitHub, Visual Studio Code, Arduino IDE, Arduino-based physical computing, Processing, HBuilderX, p5.js
 - *Programming Languages:* JavaScript, C++, Python, C#
- **Interests & Activities:** Skiing; Basketball (Two-time University Champion); Marathon Running (Completed Tieling Marathon (China) and Southampton Marathon (UK); Hiking/Trekking (Experienced in notable mountain regions across the UK, Europe and China); Photography; Travel; Fashion; Vlogging.